

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-II.4: Participles and the Ablative Absolute

Form and attach participles, preserve their relative time and voice, and expand or compress ablative absolutes without changing agency

Stage	Stage II — Core Grammar
Prerequisite	EL-II.3 mastery: distinguish infinitive structures and preserve relative time
Next	EL-II.5, Subjunctive Morphology and Sequence of Tenses

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

Contents

I	Lesson	1
1	Participles and the ablative absolute	1
1.1	Forms and logic	1
1.2	Reading the forms in context	2
1.3	Writing laboratory	3
II	Practice	4
1	Transfer, retrieval, and application	4
1.1	Forms and logic — transfer practice	4
1.2	Reading the forms in context — transfer practice	4
1.3	Writing laboratory — transfer practice	4
III	Worksheets	5
1	Participles and ablative absolutes: parallel forms	5
	Worksheet II.13 — Participles A	5
	Worksheet II.16 — Participles D	7
IV	Assessment	8
1	Mastery assessment and record	8
V	Answer Key	9
1	Practice models and rubrics	9
2	Participles and ablative absolutes: parallel forms	10
	Solution II.13 — Participles A	10
	Solution II.16 — Participles D	11
VI	Scope and Sources	12
1	Scope and Qualifications	12
1.1	Packet boundary	12
1.2	Controlling records and local state	12
2	References	12
2.1	Primary corpus	12
2.2	Grammar and lexicography	13
2.3	Citation convention	13
3	Generation Metadata	13

Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Participles and the ablative absolute

On completing this unit, you can:

- form and translate present active, perfect passive, and future active participles;
- handle active-perfect participles of deponents and the irregular *mortuus*;
- distinguish attributive, circumstantial, supplementary, and periphrastic uses;
- recognize and unpack an ablative absolute without inventing a false subject.

1.1 Forms and logic

A **participle** is a verbal adjective: it agrees with a noun in gender, number, and case while retaining verbal features such as voice, relative time, objects, and adverbial modifiers. An **attributive participle** directly modifies or identifies a noun. A **circumstantial participle** supplies the time, cause, concession, means, or attendant circumstance of an action. A **supplementary participle** completes the sense of certain verbs of perceiving or depicting. A **periphrastic** combines a participle or gerundive with a form of *sum* to express a verbal idea as a unit.

The participial system

Participle	Model	Relative time	Voice and formation
Present active	<i>amans, amantis</i>	simultaneous	active; present stem + <i>-ns/-ntis</i> , third-declension one-termination adjective
Perfect passive	<i>amatus, -a, -um</i>	prior	passive; fourth principal part, first/second-declension adjective
Future active	<i>amaturus, -a, -um</i>	subsequent or intended	active; supine stem + <i>-urus</i>
Gerundive	<i>amandus, -a, -um</i>	no tense	passive necessity or purpose; treated fully in Unit 12

Latin lacks an ordinary perfect active participle, but deponents supply one with active meaning: *secutus*, “having followed”; *locutus*, “having spoken.” Likewise *mortuus* means “having died/dead.” Participles agree with a noun in gender, number, and case while retaining verbal powers such as objects and adverbs.

Ablative absolute

An ablative absolute normally contains a noun/pronoun plus a participle, both ablative, and is grammatically detached (*absolutus*) from the main clause. Translate the logical relation demanded by context: “when,” “after,” “because,” “although,” or “with . . .” Present participle = action simultaneous with the main verb; perfect participle = prior action. A noun or adjective may stand without a participle because Latin has no present participle of *sum*: *Christo duce*, “with Christ as leader.”

Do not call a phrase absolute if its noun is also a required argument of the main verb. Do not automatically translate a perfect passive participle actively: *pane accepto* is “when the bread had been received/taken,” with context supplying the agent.

1.2 Reading the forms in context

Worked example: present participle in the institution narrative

Worked passage ID: W.II.13; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Accipiens et hunc præclarum calicem in sanctas ac venerabiles manus suas, item tibi gratias agens, benedixit.

Analysis. Nominative *accipiens* and *agens* agree with the implicit subject Christ and denote actions simultaneous with or immediately attendant on *benedixit*. *calicem* is object of *accipiens*; *tibi* is dative with *gratias agens*.

Translation. “Taking also this noble chalice into his holy and venerable hands, and likewise giving thanks to you, he blessed it.”

Worked example: perfect participles in the Creed

Worked passage ID: W.II.14; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Genitum, non factum, consubstantialem Patri.

Analysis. Accusative masculine singular *genitum* and *factum* agree with *Filium* from the preceding line; both are perfect passive participles. The contrast is theological and grammatical: “begotten,” not “made.” Predicate adjective *consubstantialem* also agrees with *Filium*.

Translation. “Begotten, not made, of one substance with the Father.”

Worked example: ablative absolute in the Canon

Worked passage ID: W.II.15; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Qui, pridie quam pateretur, accepit panem in sanctas ac venerabiles manus suas, et elevatis oculis in cælum ... benedixit.

Analysis. In *elevatis oculis*, both words are ablative masculine plural. The perfect passive participle marks an action prior to *benedixit*; *oculis* has no syntactic role in the main clause.

Translation. “He, on the day before he suffered, took bread into his holy and venerable hands and, when his eyes had been raised to heaven, blessed it.”

Worked example: participles sharing the main subject (Matthew 2:11)

Worked passage ID: W.II.16; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Et intrantes domum invenerunt puerum cum Maria matre eius, et procidentes adoraverunt eum.

Analysis. *Intrantes* and *procidentes* are present active nominative plural participles, from active *intro* and *procido*; they introduce attendant actions of the same people who *invenerunt* and *adoraverunt*. Neither is an ablative absolute because both share the main subject. Compare Matthew 8:23, *secuti sunt eum discipuli eius*: deponent *secuti sunt* has perfect morphology but active meaning, “his disciples followed him.”

Translation. “Entering the house, they found the child with Mary his mother, and falling down they adored him.”

1.3 Writing laboratory

Write all four participial stems for *amo*, *moneo*, *rego*, *cipio*, *audio*; decline *regens* in singular and plural and *benedictus* in all genders. Copy *elevatis oculis in cælum* and draw a box around the absolute phrase.

Compress these pairs: *Sacerdos orat et hostiam offert* → *Sacerdos orans hostiam offert*; *Oculi elevati sunt*; *Christus benedixit* → *Oculis elevatis, Christus benedixit*. Compose one ablative absolute with a present participle and one with a perfect participle, then expand each into a finite *cum*-clause.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 Forms and logic — transfer practice

Connection. An attachment checklist makes controller, agreement, voice, and relative time explicit before interpretation.

Transfer task. For each participle type in the lesson, fill five boxes: dictionary verb, morphology, agreeing controller, voice, and time relative to the finite verb. Include one deponent perfect participle.

Retrieval check. Explain why perfect morphology does not always mean passive sense in a deponent.

1.2 Reading the forms in context — transfer practice

Connection. A participle can be attributive, circumstantial, supplementary, or periphrastic even when its morphology is unchanged.

Transfer task. Classify the lesson's contextual participles by attachment and use. Draw an arrow to each controller and write the clause evidence that rules out one neighboring classification.

Retrieval check. Name the evidence needed before translating a participle as a full subordinate clause.

1.3 Writing laboratory — transfer practice

Connection. Expansion pairs expose whether an ablative absolute retains its own controller and chronology.

Transfer task. Use the lesson's finite-to-absolute patterns to create one present-participle and one perfect-participle pair. Label the controller and relative time on both sides, then reverse the transformation.

Retrieval check. State what must remain unchanged through both directions.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Participles and ablative absolutes: parallel forms

Worksheet II.13 — Participles A

Worksheet ID: II.13

Focus: formation, agreement, relative time, ablative absolute

Use: Name the controller and relative time before translating a participle.

1. Form the present active, perfect passive, and future active participles of *amo*.

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2. Parse *elevatis oculis* and state its time relation to *benedixit*.
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3. Compress: *Sacerdos orat et hostiam offert.*
-

4. Expand *pane accepto, gratias egit* with *postquam*.
-

5. **Text:** *Accipiens et hunc præclarum calicem in sanctas ac venerabiles manus suas, item tibi gratias agens, benedixit.*

Passage ID: II.13.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse both participles and translate.

6. Write in Latin: “When the gifts had been blessed, the priest raised the chalice.”
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Worksheet II.16 — Participles D**Worksheet ID:** II.16**Focus:** formation, agreement, relative time, ablative absolute**Use:** Name the controller and relative time before translating a participle.

1. Decline present participle *orans* in nominative, genitive, accusative, and ablative, singular and plural.

2. Distinguish *amatus*, *amaturus*, and *amandus*.

3. Compress with an absolute: *Verba audita sunt; fideles crediderunt*.

4. Translate both possible relations of *hostia oblata*, *sacerdos oravit*.

5. **Text:** *Qui pridie quam pateretur, accepit panem in sanctas ac venerabiles manus suas, et elevatis oculis in cælum benedixit.*

Passage ID: II.16.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

This controlled abridgment deletes received words between *in cælum* and *benedixit*; locate the participle and absolute.

6. Write one present and one perfect absolute from “the priest prays / the gifts are received.”

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Form and decline at least 90 percent of fifteen prompted participles, identify every participle's controller and relative time in an unseen passage, and convert four finite/absolute pairs without changing agency or chronology.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-II.5, Subjunctive Morphology and Sequence of Tenses.

If it is not met: Worksheets II.14 and II.15 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

Forms and logic — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Every ordinary perfect passive participle carries passive voice, but a deponent's perfect participle has the active lexical sense identified by its dictionary entry. Agreement and relative time remain independently stated.

Reading the forms in context — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The answer must identify controller agreement, finite verb, semantic relation, and discourse context. A subordinate-clause English rendering is acceptable only when it preserves the participle's voice and relative time without inventing an unsupported relation.

Writing laboratory — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The same proposition, agency, controller, voice, and relative chronology must survive. The absolute pair uses ablative agreement and remains grammatically detached; its finite expansion may choose a contextually justified conjunction but may not invent causality or concession.

CHAPTER 2

Participles and ablative absolutes: parallel forms

Solution II.13 — Participles A

Worksheet ID: II.13

Focus: formation, agreement, relative time, ablative absolute**Use:** Name the controller and relative time before translating a participle.

1. Form the present active, perfect passive, and future active participles of *amo*.
Answer / model: *amans, amantis; amatus, -a, -um; amaturus, -a, -um*.
2. Parse *elevatis oculis* and state its time relation to *benedixit*.
Answer / model: Both are ablative masculine plural; *elevatis* is perfect passive participle of *elevo*. The absolute action is prior: “when/after his eyes had been raised.”
3. Compress: *Sacerdos orat et hostiam offert*.
Answer / model: *Sacerdos orans hostiam offert*. Nominative singular *orans* shares the subject and is simultaneous.
4. Expand *pane accepto, gratias egit* with *postquam*.
Answer / model: *Postquam panem accepit, gratias egit*. The perfect passive absolute becomes a prior active finite clause because context supplies the same agent.
5. **Text:** *Accipiens et hunc præclarum calicem in sanctas ac venerabiles manus suas, item tibi gratias agens, benedixit*.
Passage ID: II.13.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Parse both participles and translate.
Answer / notes: *Accipiens* and *agens* are nominative singular present active participles agreeing with implicit Christ; each is attendant on *benedixit*. “Taking also this noble chalice into his holy and venerable hands and likewise giving thanks to you, he blessed it.”
6. Write in Latin: “When the gifts had been blessed, the priest raised the chalice.”
Answer / model: *Donis benedictis, sacerdos calicem elevavit*. *Donis benedictis* is neuter ablative plural and grammatically detached.

Solution II.16 — Participles D

Worksheet ID: II.16

Focus: formation, agreement, relative time, ablative absolute

Use: Name the controller and relative time before translating a participle.

- Decline present participle *orans* in nominative, genitive, accusative, and ablative, singular and plural.
Answer / model: Singular nom. *orans*, gen. *orantis*, acc. *orantem* (neuter *orans*), abl. *orante*; plural nom. *orantes* (neuter *orantia*), gen. *orantium*, acc. *orantes/orantia*, abl. *orantibus*.
- Distinguish *amatus*, *amaturus*, and *amandus*.
Answer / model: Perfect passive participle, prior/passive; future active participle, subsequent/active; gerundive, passive necessity or purpose and no tense.
- Compress with an absolute: *Verba audita sunt; fideles crediderunt*.
Answer / model: *Verbis auditis, fideles crediderunt*. Neuter plural *verbis auditis* is prior.
- Translate both possible relations of *hostia oblata, sacerdos oravit*.
Answer / model: Temporally, “after the victim had been offered, the priest prayed”; causally, “because the victim had been offered, the priest prayed.” Context, not the absolute alone, selects.
- Text:** *Qui pridie quam pateretur, accepit panem in sanctas ac venerabiles manus suas, et elevatis oculis in cælum benedixit.*
Passage ID: II.16.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
 This controlled abridgment deletes received words between *in cælum* and *benedixit*; locate the participle and absolute.
Answer / notes: *Elevatis oculis* is ablative absolute, perfect and prior to *benedixit*. “Who, on the day before he suffered, took bread into his holy and venerable hands and, when his eyes had been raised to heaven, blessed it.”
- Write one present and one perfect absolute from “the priest prays / the gifts are received.”
Answer / model: *Sacerdote orante, dona accipiuntur; donis acceptis, sacerdos orat*. The first is simultaneous active; the second prior passive.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-II.4, *Participles and the Ablative Absolute*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This packet teaches the central participial system; contextual English may vary while controller, voice, and chronology remain fixed.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-21T17:50:56Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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